THE GOLDEN RULES

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SLIDEHEROES

GOLDEN RULE

FOLLOW A PROCESS

Follow a Who, Why, What and How process

GOLDEN RULE

OUR AUDIENCE IS THE HERO

We are creating a presentation that makes our audience the hero, meets their needs and addresses What Is In It For Them

GOLDEN RULE

WE ARE CREATING OUR PRESENTATION TO ANSWER A QUESTION IN THE MIND OF OUR AUDIENCE

The reason we are creating a presentation, is always to answer a question that is in the mind of our audience.

GOLDEN RULE

FACTS KNOWN BY THE AUDIENCE GO IN THE INTRODUCTION

If our audience already knows something, the place for this is in the introduction, not in our answer to the question

GOLDEN RULE

OUR OBJECTIVE IS TO COMPEL OUR AUDIENCE TO DO SOMETHING

The objective of our presentation is always for the Audience to 'Do Something' after the presentation.

GOLDEN RULE

CREATE IDEAS FIRST, SLIDES SECOND

Develop our initial ideas outside of our presentation tool to ensure they retain their malleability

PRINCIPLE OF ABSTRACTION: THREE GOLDEN RULES

EACH LEVEL SUMMARIZES CONCEPTS GROUPED BELOW

- Concepts at any level must be more abstract summaries of the concepts that are grouped below

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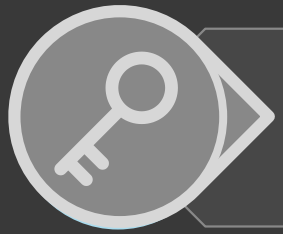

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IDEAS PRESENTED IN LOGICAL ORDER

- Concepts at an level must be presented in a strict logical order

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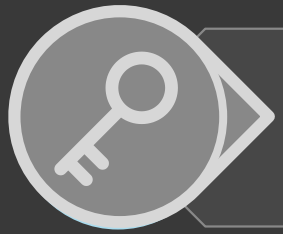

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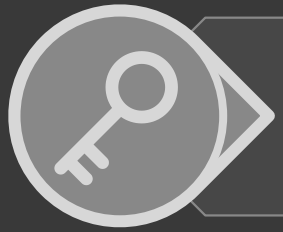

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GROUPS OF CONCEPTS ALWAYS THE SAME KIND OF IDEA

- Concepts in any group are always the same kind of idea

GOLDEN RULE

USE INDUCTIVE ARGUMENTS

Inductive arguments are easier for an audience to absorb because they require less effort to understand

TEACHING THROUGH STORIES A PARABLE

In a faraway land, a boy went to learn at the feet of a wise man day after day. The wise man always instructed the boy through stories.

One day, the boy asked “Master, why do you always teach through stories? Would it not be faster to teach me directly?”

To this, the wise man answered “Please bring me some tea.”

The boy rose and prepared a cup of tea in a white china cup.

The wise man took the cup from the boy and sipped it, then asked “Why did you bring me a cup when I only asked for the tea?”

GOLDEN RULE

MAKE USE OF WORDS & GRAPHICS

Our presentations must use a combination of words and graphics to communicate our messages in order to reach people with all types of learning preferences

GOLDEN RULE

OUR DESIGN GOAL IS HARMONY AND SIMPLICITY

Simplicity is not an aesthetic preference, rather, it is a tool. We are aiming to communicate our message as efficiently as possible – simplicity services this goal

GOLDEN RULE

COMPOSE SLIDE TO REINFORCE MAIN MESSAGE

Slide composition and design must always be in support of communicating the main message of the slide

HEADLINES RULES OF THUMB

No longer than **two lines**

Headline needs to be scanable

Font size **no smaller than 22 point**

Headline needs to be readable

GOLDEN RULE

MAKE ARGUMENTS WITH FACTS

To convince and persuade in today's corporate world business people must construct evidence-based arguments. They must demonstrate, not simply assert.

GRAPHICAL EXCELLENCE

1

EFFICIENT
Gives the viewer the greatest number of ideas, in the shortest time, with the least ink, in the smallest space

2

MULTIVARIATE
Is nearly always multivariate - involving more than one variable

3

HONEST
Requires telling the truth with the data

GOLDEN RULE

DON'T USE PIE CHARTS

Our visual perception is not designed to accurately assign quantitative information to 2D areas. We have an even harder time when the third dimension of depth is added.

GOLDEN RULE

ANSWER YOUR AUDIENCE'S QUESTIONS

Answer your audience's questions. Even when they do not know how to properly frame their confusion as a question.